The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra "The Blessing of All the Tathāgatas, Watching over Sentient Beings and Fully Displaying the Arrangement of the Buddhafields"

Āryasarvatathāgatādhiṣṭhānasattvāvalokanabuddhakṣetranirdeśanavyūhanāmamahāyānasūtra · Toh 98 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་དཔེའཞིའ་གཤགས་པ་ཐམས་ཅད་ཀྱིའི་གཏུགས་སམེས་ཅན་ལ་གཟགིས་ཤདེ་སངས་རྒྱས་ཀྱིའི་ཞིང་གི་བཀོད་པ་ཀན་ཏུ་སྟན་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱ་ཐགེ་པ་ཚནེ་པའོ་མེད།།

The Blessing of All the Tathāgatas, Watching over Sentient Beings and Fully Displaying the Arrangement of the Buddhafields is a Great Vehicle sūtra whose Sanskrit title is given as Ārya Sarvatathāgatādhiṣṭhānasattvāvalokanabuddhakṣetranirdeśanavyūha, and whose Tibetan title begins Phakpa Dezhin Shekpa Tamché kyi Jingyi Lap Semchen la Zik shing Sangyé kyi Zhing gi. The discourse opens on Mount Potalaka, the jewel-adorned abode of the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, where the Buddha is dwelling with a great assembly of about five hundred monks, all of them arhats free of defilements. As its title suggests, the sūtra concerns the blessing power of all the buddhas, their compassionate watch over living beings, and a revelation of the splendid arrangements of the buddhafields. It is Toh 98 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the general sūtra section of Mahāyāna discourses.

In the language of India: ārya sarva ta thā ga ta a dhiṣṭhā na sa tvā ba lo ke na bud dha kṣe tra nir de śa na byū ha nā ma ma hā yā na sū tra

In the language of Tibet: The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra called "The Blessing of All the Tathāgatas, Watching over Sentient Beings and Fully Displaying the Arrangement of the Buddhafields."

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One (the Buddha) was dwelling on Mount Potalaka, at the abode of the noble Avalokiteśvara. It was arrayed with precious divine jewels of glorious essence, with flowers in full bloom, and with a divine lion throne. He was there together with a great Saṅgha of about five hundred monks. All of them were arhats, their defilements exhausted, and every one of them had reached the far shore of supreme mastery over all sentient beings.

There were also seven hundred bodhisattva great beings. All of them dwelt in the knowledge of great compassion. All were bound to just one more birth, or two births, three births, ten births, twenty births, thirty births, up to a hundred births. Every one of them abided on the eighth ground or the tenth ground. Among them were the noble Avalokiteśvara, Mañjuśrī, Vimalaketu, Dhanaśrī, Vidyutketu, Vimalaprabha, Candana, Amṛtaketu, and others.

There were also five thousand laymen and laywomen, gathered from various world systems. All of them had received prophecies and attained meditative absorption.

There were also a hundred thousand gods, nāgas, yakṣas, and gandharvas. All of them had served the buddhas of the past and had seen the miracles of the Tathāgata.

There were also eighty great yakṣiṇīs. All of them had attained the wisdom of bodhisattvas, had received prophecies, and were irreversible. Among them were Anupamā, Vimalaprabhā, Prabhāvatī, Bhīṣaṇī, Śrīmatī, Hārītī, Śaṅkhinī, and others.

And there were Śakra (Indra), Brahmā, Vaiśravaṇa, Dhṛtarāṣṭra, Virūḍhaka, Virūpākṣa, the son of Maṇibhadra, Pūrṇabhadra, and others, up to and including all the world protectors.

Then all of them, knowing that the Tathāgata was seated upon the lion throne, made offerings to the Tathāgata, each by means of their own roots of virtue, with divine ornaments, garments, flowers, garlands, incense, ointments, and the sounds of music, and they paid him reverence. Some circumambulated him many hundreds of thousands of times and praised him.

At that time the Blessed One entered into the meditative absorption called "Dwelling in the Knowledge of Great Compassion That Focuses on All Sentient Beings." Through the power of that meditative absorption, this great trichiliocosm, this world system of a billion worlds, became illuminated with light, and all forms were pervaded by radiance.

Then those sentient beings who were blind came to see forms with their eyes. The deaf came to hear sounds with their ears. Those stricken with illness became free of their illnesses. Those without clothing obtained clothing. The insane regained their mindfulness. Those with damaged bodies and impaired faculties came to have complete bodies and faculties. The poor obtained wealth. Those sentient beings who had no wealth, provisions, or possessions

came to have wealth, provisions, and possessions. All sentient beings came to possess every happiness, and all their wishes were completely fulfilled.

All the sentient beings of the great trichiliocosm were urged on, so that every one of them would come to hear the Dharma, and they came to where the Blessed One was. Those sentient beings born among the gods all gave up the pleasures of the gods, recollected the Buddha, and came to where the Blessed One was in order to hear the Dharma. Those sentient beings born among humans also gave up human pleasures and came to where the Blessed One was in order to hear the Dharma. Those sentient beings born among the nāgas, yakṣas, rākṣasas, hungry ghosts, and piśācas also each attained recollection of the Buddha, dwelt in loving-kindness toward all sentient beings, and, happy in body and mind, came to where the Blessed One was in order to hear the Dharma.

Those sentient beings born in the realms of Yama, in darkness and pitch blackness, also, through the power of the Buddha, each regained awareness for a single moment. They came to recognize one another, and they were completely freed from that great darkness. All sentient beings dwelt in loving-kindness toward one another and became free of the secondary afflictions.

At that time this great earth quaked in six ways, rising up and sinking down.

Then Mañjuśrī, the youthful one, joined that gathered assembly and sat down, and he spoke these words to the bodhisattva great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara:

"Son of noble family, a great assembly of bodhisattvas is appearing everywhere, and the portents of a great assembly are appearing everywhere as well. Son of noble family, the prophecies of many hundreds of thousands of millions of billions of bodhisattvas are also appearing everywhere, and the portents of a great discourse connected with the Dharma are appearing everywhere as well. From this, son of noble family, all the hopes of many hundreds of thousands of millions of billions of bodhisattvas will be completely fulfilled, and they will also attain great wisdom. Therefore, son of noble family, generate compassion for all sentient beings, and, for the sake of their benefit, their happiness, and even their establishment in unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, make your request to the Tathāgata.

"Son of noble family, in the future, in times to come, there will appear sentient beings who do evil, who are poor, weak, and of ugly complexion, tormented by

old age and sickness, of meager wealth, their bodies uncultivated, short-lived, of little intelligence, and tormented by attachment, aversion, and delusion. Son of noble family, so that the Dharma may be taught for their sake, make your petition to the Tathāgata. Son of noble family, in this way you will have accomplished, for a long time to come, the aim of sentient beings, their benefit and happiness, the complete pacification of all illness, the averting of all evil, the complete pacification of all evil, the complete fulfillment of all hopes, and even unsurpassed parinirvāṇa."

Then the bodhisattva great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara, looked out in the ten directions and brought to mind tathāgatas as numerous as tens of millions of times the grains of sand in the river Ganges. Toward where the Blessed One (the Buddha) was, he bowed with palms joined, circumambulated him three times, prostrated with the five limbs of his body, and addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One, in the future, in times to come, there will appear sentient beings overwhelmed by old age, sickness, death, and sorrow, tormented by untimely death, weak, of ugly complexion, short-lived, of meager wealth, their bodies uncultivated. With minds of avarice and corrupt moral discipline they will kill one another, and they will rob one another of wealth, possessions, and power. They will amuse themselves with laughter, flirtation, song and dance, and games, and they will perceive the impermanent as permanent and the unattractive as attractive. Why is this? Because, by that cause and on that basis, sentient beings are harmed by many kinds of non-virtue, and so they are reborn in the hells, in the wombs of animals, and in the world of Yama. Therefore, Blessed One, for their aim, their benefit and happiness, for the complete fulfillment of all their hopes, and even for their attainment of the wisdom of the Tathāgata, for their birth in buddha fields, and for the averting of all evil, I wish to petition the Tathāgata.

"Blessed One, since there is nothing at all that the Tathāgata does not know, has not realized, has not seen, has not heard, or does not discern, we wish to hear a discourse connected with the Dharma. So that the many who have gathered here, those who have served the buddhas of the past, bodhisattvas whose very nature is endowed with wisdom, monks, nuns, laymen, laywomen, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas, may be left with nothing further to hope for and will not need to come back again, Blessed One, please teach! Sugata, please teach!"

Then the whole assembly, all who had gathered there, also prostrated with the five limbs of their bodies and spoke these words in unison: "Blessed One, please teach well! Sugata, please teach well!"

Then the Blessed One, understanding that the request had been made a second and a third time, looked out in the ten directions, and with a voice that was pleasant, sweet, and delightful, he spoke these words to the bodhisattva great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara:

"Son of good family, there is a samādhi called Beholding Beings with the Blessing of All Tathāgatas and Fully Displaying the Arrays of Buddha Fields. I first heard it long ago, when I first set my mind on awakening, in the presence of the Tathāgata called Fully Displaying the Light of Flowers. Son of good family, the moment they heard the name of that samādhi, nine hundred million beings attained the wisdom of a tathāgata, and that Tathāgata prophesied that every one of them would awaken in a different buddha field. I too received a prophecy then.

"Son of good family, with the divine knowledge of a tathāgata I know that in the past thirty thousand tathāgatas taught this Dharma discourse for the sake of all sentient beings. On every one of those occasions, the ones who made the request of the Tathāgata were you yourself, noble Avalokiteśvara, and Mañjuśrī, the youthful one. Assemblies of bodhisattva great beings, and assemblies of monks, nuns, laymen and laywomen, gathered just as these here have gathered, also heard it, and they made images and offerings. After that, many hundreds of thousands of millions of billions of beings received prophecies and also attained the samādhis of bodhisattvas. They went wherever they wished, all their hopes were fulfilled, and they were also freed from illness. Their roots of virtue fully ripened, they abandoned all obscurations, and they became well-formed and beautiful, pleasing to behold. They were rich in wealth, grain, treasuries and storehouses. They were worthy of praise by kings, princes and ministers, and worthy of homage from all sentient beings. They had mindfulness, they had wisdom, and they had unshakable faith in the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha. They had miraculous powers, and they had long life, fine complexion, splendor and might, and possessed the very best in every respect. They were never separated from those they loved, and they were without the suffering that comes through loved ones. This I remember.

"Son of good family, therefore, those sons or daughters of good family who give rise to supreme reverence for the preacher of the Dharma, who prostrate with the five limbs to this Dharma discourse, who adorn it beautifully with flowers, incense, perfumes, garlands, ointments, parasols, victory banners and flags, who say 'Homage to the Buddha' and bow down, who applaud it with the word 'Excellent!', and who take it up, keep it, read it, write it out and have it written out, will be endowed with many good qualities.

"Even in this very life they will be endowed with many good qualities. They will be well-formed and beautiful, pleasing to behold; free from illness; long-lived; steady of intellect; possessed of mindfulness; and possessed of steadfastness. They will be worthy of praise, worthy of homage and worthy of veneration by all kings, all queens, all princes, all ministers, all enemies and all sentient beings. They will also have much wealth and many possessions. The fragrance of sandalwood will waft from their mouths. Their eyes will be like the petals of the blue lotus. Day and night they will see buddhas and bodhisattvas. All their obscurations, beginning with the five acts of immediate retribution, will be exhausted. The gods will protect them. At the time of death they will see buddhas and bodhisattvas. They will die without jealousy and without distraction of mind. And after they have died and passed on, they will even be reborn in the world realm of Sukhāvatī.

"Son of good family, those who take up this Dharma discourse, who honor it and write it out, have it written out, read it, make offerings to it, keep it, or merely hear its name, are prophesied by my direct prophecy. Since they have seen me, honored me, made images of me and made offerings to me, they should not give rise to doubt about the awakening of the buddhas. Those in whose hearing it has resounded should likewise be regarded as bodhisattvas and should be honored.

"All the karmic obscurations that come from the maturation of one's former karma, namely ugliness, poverty, lack of intelligence, great craving, separation from loved ones, turmoil in the kingdom, headaches, lack of food, poor clothing, harm to body and mind, bedding unpleasant to the touch, and being reviled, will be completely exhausted by the power of hearing this samādhi.

"Such a person should resolve thus: 'Whatever various unwholesome misdeeds I accumulated toward sentient beings in the past while wandering in saṃsāra, I shall confess each one. I shall purge them. I shall not conceal them.'

One should give rise to a mind endowed with unshakable faith in the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha. Then, for that son or daughter of good family, the karmic obscuration by which wealth bears no fruit, and whatever evil deeds have been done and accumulated toward the Buddha, the Dharma, the Saṅgha, the śrāvakas, the pratyekabuddhas and one's father and mother, will all be completely exhausted, and great sovereignty too will be fully attained.

"For that son or daughter of good family, the karmic obscuration that would cause one to experience the suffering of beings in hell, and whatever would cause one to be separated from loved ones, to become blind, to take the state of a woman, to be of both sexes, and, under the sway of jealousy, pride and anger, to be born in the world of Yama, among the hungry ghosts or in the wombs of animals, will all be completely exhausted. Son of good family, in this way this samādhi is the source of all good qualities."

Noble son, this Dharma discourse has secret mantra foundations of dhāraṇī. They make it endure for a long time. They guard, protect and shelter those noble sons and noble daughters. They bring all their good qualities and all their hopes to complete fulfillment. They bring enjoyments, sovereignty and great happiness, and make all their intentions and desires succeed. They exhaust all karma. They fully pacify untimely death, all bad dreams and all illnesses. They bring victory in every battle. They increase life, complexion, strength, diligence and might. They bring under control all yakṣas, bhūtas, humans and nonhumans. They fully pacify all epidemics, poisons, fires and floods. They bring about every attainment, up to and including the receiving of a prophecy. Noble sons and noble daughters who hear them, retain them and honor them, who read them, write them out and have them written out, will obtain all those good qualities.

Then at that time this great earth quaked in six ways. The assemblies, just as they had gathered, offered to the body of the Tathāgata flowers, incense, perfumes, garlands, powders, ointments and pairs of cloth garments. They said "Excellent!" and then asked, "Blessed One, excellent, excellent! What are those secret mantra foundations of dhāraṇī?"

The Blessed One said:
namaḥ sarva tathāgatānān tadyathā buddhe subuddhe buddhamate loke viloke loka atikrānte satva avalokini sarva tathāgata adhiṣṭhāna adhiṣṭhite sarva āśa paripūraṇe vyutina dhare naradeva pūjite tathāgata jñāna dade tathāgata adhiṣṭhānena sarva lokama sukhī bhavatu pūrva karma kṣāpayatu

rakṣa bhavatu sarva yebhyastathāgata adhiṣṭhānena svāhā

"O noble sons, these secret mantra foundations of dhāraṇī were spoken and blessed by thirty thousand tathāgatas. I too now teach them for the welfare, benefit and happiness of all sentient beings, to guard, protect and shelter them, to fully pacify all illnesses, and so that they may be born in buddha fields.

"Friends, whoever thinks, 'How might I obtain all those good qualities spoken of by the Tathāgata?' should rise early in the morning. With a tender heart toward all sentient beings, a mind of compassion and a mind of loving-kindness, a mind that has entirely abandoned jealousy, pride, concealment and anger, and a one-pointed mind, he should make very extensive offerings to the buddhas and bodhisattvas and bow to all the tathāgatas of the ten directions. Then, bringing to mind whatever he wishes for, he should recite the mantra one hundred and eight times over flowers and offer them one by one to the Tathāgata. In this way all his hopes will be fulfilled. He will also see the Tathāgata in his dreams. He will also obtain whatever excellent thing he desires. At the time of death he will also see the Tathāgata. After dying and passing on, he will be born in the world realm of Sukhāvatī. He will also be endowed with long life, strength, complexion and diligence. All his enemies, too, will come under his control."

When this dhāraṇī was taught, sixty thousand living beings attained acceptance of the nonarising of phenomena. All of them were freed from every karmic obscuration, and all their intentions were completely fulfilled.

Then the bodhisattva great being Vajrapāṇi looked around in the ten directions and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, there is a dhāraṇī called Fearless Splendor of the Bodhisattvas' Vow. I received it in the presence of the Tathāgata Fearless Array, King of Splendor, and having received it, I taught it to all sentient beings. Blessed One, from this day on I declare with full knowledge that it is impossible for anyone in whose ears this dhāraṇī has sounded, or who has taken it to heart, to be harmed in body by distress, by various afflictions, by fevers, by epidemics, by bodily pains, by torment of mind, or by untimely death. It is impossible for them to suffer danger from water, danger from weapons, danger from poison, danger from poisoners, or danger from ḍākinīs and bhūtas, or to be scorned, harassed or harmed by yakṣas, by enemies, or by humans and nonhumans. Therefore, may the Blessed One grant me permission, and I shall bestow the seals of the

bodhisattvas' vow, which completely fulfill all the hopes of those who listen, those who make paintings, those who make offerings and those who retain it, for the sake of the teachers of the Dharma and those who listen to the Dharma."

namaḥ sarva tathāgatānān sarva bodhisatvānān arahātāna tadyathā oṃ vajradhara vajrakāya vajrabala vajrateja hūṃ hūṃ vajrapāṇi tathāgata ājñāma balāya smara pratijñāma sarva vyādhīn sarva pāpān nāśaya dehi me yathaiva sitam varam yan yameva abhiprāyan yācami tantameva samṛdhyatu he he turu turu āgaccha āgaccha mā pilamba darṣaya vajrakāyam darṣaya vajrakāyam buddha adhiṣṭhānena svāhā

When this dhāraṇī was recited, this great earth rose and sank. All the yakṣas and rākṣasas were terrified. All the gods, and all beings up to humans and nonhumans, were filled with wonder, and they cried out, "Excellent, excellent is the teaching of these secret mantra foundations of dhāraṇī, which bring great beings to full accomplishment!"

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Vajrapāṇi, said this to the Blessed One (the Buddha): "Venerable Blessed One, suppose someone wishes for a bodhisattva ground, or for mastery over wealth, grain and possessions, or for mastery over a kingdom, or for the state of a holder of vidyā-mantras, or for life, strength, a fine complexion, diligence and long life. That person should first carry out the approach practice. Then, on the eighth day of the waxing fortnight of the month, they should set up a Vajradhara made of white sandalwood, one span in height, adorned with every ornament, with relics placed at its heart. They should perform the rite that fully brings to life this Vajradhara, the holder of vidyā-mantras, together with its relics. They should perfume it with pure incense and keep a fast for one day and one night.

"Then, from the eighth day to the fifteenth, in a clean place where an image of the Tathāgata is installed, they should make a maṇḍala of white sandalwood and set out four full vases. In the four directions they should offer tormas of flavorful food, of fragrant things, of drink and of milk porridge. Wearing white cloth and with a one-pointed mind, they should make a great offering three times a day with incense, flowers, perfume and lamps. They should also make offerings to the Tathāgata, and having bowed to the Tathāgata, they should recite the mantra a hundred and eight times over a hundred and eight jasmine flowers, and strike Vajrapāṇi with them one by one.

"Then a great sound will arise, the earth will tremble, and rays of light will appear. Then I shall grant whatever supreme thing is wished for. Merely by doing the recitation, every rite and every aim will be fully accomplished. That person will be free of illness, will live long, will be free of all wrongdoing, and will gain a thousand good qualities. At the time of death they will see a thousand buddhas, blessed ones. I shall also let them see me."

Then the Blessed One praised Vajrapāṇi, saying, "Excellent! Vajrapāṇi, excellent, excellent! This seal cannot be transgressed by the world with its gods. Have no doubt about it, no wavering and no uncertainty."

Then Mañjuśrī, the youthful one, said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, why is this samādhi called Blessed by All the Tathāgatas, Watching Over Beings and Fully Displaying the Arrays of the Buddha Fields?"

The Blessed One said: "Through the blessing of all the tathāgatas and the blessing of all the bodhisattvas, one attains every samādhi and every door of dhāraṇī. Free of any agitation oneself, one fully knows the stirrings of the minds and mental factors of all beings: of the gods, the nāgas, humans, yakṣas, gandharvas, hungry ghosts, those born in the animal realm, and the beings of Yama's world. One knows, 'These beings are headed toward merit; they do deeds of good conduct and will gain faith in the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha. These are beings headed for hell; they do deeds of misconduct and practice evil.' Knowing this, one teaches the Dharma to those beings who hold evil views, turns them back from all evil, establishes them in the awakening of a buddha, fulfills all their aspirations, and dispels their jealousy, pride, anger and avarice. Those beings too, having gained faith in the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha, are born in the buddha fields, never again experience suffering, and never become unhappy. Therefore, son of noble family, for that reason this samādhi is called Blessed by All the Tathāgatas, Watching Over Beings and Fully Displaying the Arrays of the Buddha Fields. Beings who hear it will attain the ground that is certain to be irreversible."

Mañjuśrī asked: "Blessed One, why will those sons and daughters of noble family receive the prophecy? Blessed One, even arhatship is difficult to attain, let alone unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. How great, then, will be their mass of merit and their practice of hardships?"

The Blessed One said: "Son of noble family, from the time I first generated the mind of awakening, I brought to completion the perfection of generosity, the

perfection of moral discipline, the perfection of patience, the perfection of diligence, the perfection of meditative concentration and the Perfection of Wisdom. I gave away my head, hands, feet, eyes and body, my beloved sons and daughters, my wives, my servants and my maidservants. Yet all that earlier accumulation of merit and accumulation of roots of virtue does not come near even a hundredth part of the merit accumulated by making offerings to this Dharma discourse, honoring it, writing it down, having it written down, reading it and holding it; of the merit accumulated by teaching it correctly to others; and of the merit accumulated by making offerings to and honoring those who proclaim the Dharma.

"Son of noble family, I mastered all the Dharma teachings that were taught, honored them, held them as supreme, revered them, made offerings to them, and having honored them, wrote them down and had them written down. Far more than that, whoever writes down this Dharma discourse, has it written down, reads it, makes offerings to it, teaches it correctly, or listens to it will gather a far greater accumulation of merit. Therefore the Tathāgata prophesies their unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening."

Why is that? Because the merit of hearing, holding, retaining, reading, worshiping, writing down, and having others write down this Dharma discourse is so difficult to come by.

Son of noble family, there are sentient beings who constantly engage in evil, who delight in eating, drinking, song and dance, who perceive the unattractive as attractive, who are full of desire, anger and malice, who perceive what is not pleasant as pleasant, who delight in weapons, abuse, threats and beatings, who never come to understand and never come to attend to the Dharma. Because of that basis of evil karma and that ignorance, they are taken over by bad spiritual friends, and they are taken over by old age, sickness, sorrow and death, so at the time of death they are tormented. When they turn their minds to anything, they see only something like a charnel ground on every side. They do not give rise to a virtuous mind, nor do they gain unshakable faith. Even after they die and pass on from there, they go on experiencing sufferings. Therefore those who lack the roots of virtue that lead to a prophecy, who have not seen the Tathāgata, and who have not received a prophecy cannot listen to this Dharma discourse, revere it, worship it, hold it, write it down, have others write it down, or even have faith in it. Nor can they honor, respect, revere or worship the preacher of the Dharma.

Son of noble family, in whatever region this Dharma discourse is widely practiced, there the deeds of the Tathāgata will take place.

Then the assembly that had gathered said to the Blessed One (the Buddha), "Excellent! Excellent, Blessed One, excellent! Blessed One, we too, as the work of the Tathāgata, will honor, respect, revere and worship that preacher of the Dharma and those who listen to the Dharma, and we will provide them with all the requisites for their comfort. We will also spread this Dharma discourse and protect it, and so this Dharma discourse will remain for a long time."

Then the Blessed One looked upon the assemblies that had gathered and said, "O sons of noble family, excellent, excellent! Do just so. Even if people do you harm, scorn you, revile you, threaten you, draw weapons against you and set themselves against you, you should listen to this Dharma discourse without regard for body or life. You should write it down, have others write it down, and read it. You should also serve that preacher of the Dharma with all the requisites for comfort. You should protect those regions, those lands and those cities from fear, harm, epidemic disease and turmoil. And you should always and continually keep those sons and daughters of noble family in mind."

Then the Blessed One spoke these verses:

"In countless thousands of koṭis of eons,
The coming of a buddha is met with only rarely;
So that in later times you will not regret it,
Sons of noble family, listen to the Dharma with care!
Those who hear of its qualities and have firm faith
Will not find samādhi hard to attain.
Compared with one who, to the foremost of two-legged beings,
For koṭis of eons as many as the Ganges' sands,
Offers wealth and grain, and likewise clothing and ornaments,
Incense, garlands and ointments,
One who has faith in this sūtra,
Who hears it, reads it, and writes it down,
Has merit that has no measure;
Such is the measure the Sugata has declared.
Compared with one who always dwells with care in solitude,
Who meditates on the dhyānas with no other thought,
Who gives away beloved sons and daughters,

And who gives up hands and feet,
Whoever holds this sūtra
Gains far more merit than that one.
This supreme sūtra is a giver of wealth;
For such a one all the lower realms are forever abandoned.
This is a giver of wealth and grain;
Whoever holds this pure sūtra,
For them no good quality is rare,
And they have abundant life, strength and diligence.
They will see the Guide, the Buddha Amitābha,
And I too will prophesy their awakening as a buddha.
For them there will never be any evil,
And they will see the world of Sukhāvatī.
Whatever karma would always come to them,
Torment of mind, illness of body, and likewise
Pain in the head, will all be exhausted,
And they will never fall into ruin.
In this very life as well, all good qualities
They will obtain just as they have thought and wished.
Therefore monks and nuns always,
Laymen, and kings, the lords of men,
Should always show respect
To the preacher of the Dharma as to the Tathāgata.
They should always take up this sūtra
And always honor those who hold it;
Honoring them with incense, garlands and ointments,
They should also have it written down.
In later times, tormented by old age,
Reviled amid many thousands of quarrels,
Wandering among the hells and the pretas,
Despised as eunuchs and those of neither sex,
Blind, and with the stench of corpses and of dogs,
They are born as women of low caste.
Greatly envious and always doing evil,
Overpowered by anger and always miserly,
Because they did not show respect to the Buddha's Dharma,
They are born into such conditions,

And there too they experience painful feelings,
And in later times as well they will be tormented.
Therefore those who hold and teach it
Should always be worshiped by them.
Whoever reviles them,
Disparages them, beats them and binds them,
Has reviled me as well;
Whoever reveres those who hold it reveres me too.
Therefore they should always honor
The preacher of the Dharma, and whoever holds, writes and reads this,
And should continually speak to them
With gentle and pleasant words."

Then the bodhisattva mahāsattva, noble Avalokiteśvara, bowed down at the feet of the Blessed One and said this to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, I recall that there is a dhāraṇī called the Miracle of Full Beholding. Long ago I heard it and took it up in the presence of a tathāgata called Light-Making Wisdom Crest. If one listens to it, takes it up, keeps it and recites it, proclaims it to others as well and honors it, and then writes it down or has it written down, one will attain the stage of irreversibility, and will also attain all the qualities that the Tathāgata has spoken of. Everything one has wished for will be perfectly accomplished. All one's karmic obscurations will be purified. One will also attain samādhi. One will be freed from fevers. One will see the buddhas, and will see the bodhisattvas as well."

Then the Blessed One gave his approval to the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara, saying, "Excellent, son of noble family, excellent! Son of noble family, you have been blessed by the Tathāgata, so speak it!"

Then the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara, bowed to all the tathāgatas of the ten directions and spoke these words of secret mantra:

namaḥ sarva tathāgatānān. sarva āśā paripūrakānān. nama āryāvalokite. śvarāya. bodhisatvāya. mahāsatvāya. mahākāruṇikāya. tadyathā. ha ha ha. ma ma ma. dhiri dhiri dhiri. śānte. braśānte. sarva pāpakṣayaṅ kari. avalokāya. kāruṇika. bodhicitta mama nasi kuru. byavalokāya. māma. smara smara. yan tvayā pūrbe. satya adhiṣṭhānaṃ kṛten. tenastyena. pacanena. sarva āśā me paripūraya. buddhakṣetram pariśodhaya. mame kaścid bihethaṃ karotu. buddha adhiṣṭhānen svāhā. tadyathā. teje teje. mahāteje.

yan mama kāya duścaritam bā. vāg duścaritama bā. mano duścaritam bā. dāridryam bā. tad sakṣāpaya. alokaya. bilokaya. tathāgata darṣaṇan ca. aham adhikāṃ. kṣāmi. bodhisatya darṣaṇam. dhudhuma. dadassva me daraṣaṇam. sarva me kuśala. abhibardhanatu. namaḥ sarva tathāgatānān. nama ālokiteśvarāya. bodhisatvāya. smara pratijñāma satva. sidhyantu mantrapadā svāhā.

As this dhāraṇī was spoken, this great earth shook violently, there was a great sound of laughter, and showers of divine flowers rained down profusely.

The entire assembly gave its approval, saying, "Excellent, son of noble family, excellent! Great being, for the protection of all sentient beings you have well spoken this dhāraṇī, which fulfills every hope, protects from every fear, purifies all karma, and fully pacifies all harm from hostility and from bad dreams. All of us too shall take it up and honor it."

Avalokiteśvara said, "Sons of noble family, whoever desires those qualities just as the Tathāgata has proclaimed them, and desires a prophecy, to see me directly, to attain samādhi, to see the buddhas and bodhisattvas, to obtain wealth and power, and to be born in a buddhafield, should during the waxing fortnight bathe the body well and be clean. Observing the fast and keeping the noble eightfold precepts, beginning from the eighth day of the month, in a place blessed by the Tathāgata, one should worship that place and the preacher of the Dharma as well with incense, flowers, victory banners, pennants and full vases. Then, having bathed the body well, clean, and dressed in white clothes, one should make offerings with flowers, incense, perfume, garlands and various ointments, and then write it down.

"While writing it, each day one should share one's roots of virtue in common with all sentient beings, and holding the Tathāgata as one's teacher with a mind of reverence, one should write it until midday, with a mind of loving-kindness, a mind of tender affection and a mind of compassion toward all sentient beings. From the eighth day until the fifteenth day one should likewise make offerings each day.

"If one writes it, having done this in exactly this way, then immediately all karmic obscurations, beginning with the five acts of immediate retribution, and all misdeeds will be purified, and one's roots of virtue will increase. One's diligence will blaze forth. In that very life one will also attain bodily well-being. Attachment, aversion, delusion, pride, anger, jealousy and avarice will grow faint.

"After having had it written, one should place, in a stupa containing relics, an image of the Tathāgata containing relics and an image of Avalokiteśvara containing relics, set facing east. One should make very extensive offerings with flowers, incense, perfume and lamps. From the eighth day until the fifteenth day one should generate the mind of great compassion toward all sentient beings, and being clean, eating white foods, observing the fast, keeping the noble eightfold precepts, having trusted companions, and having entirely given up pride, anger, jealousy and avarice, one should make vast offerings each day and perform the recitation one hundred and eight times at each of the three times of day. Offering flowers, incense, perfume and lamps, at the three times of day one should scatter one hundred and eight jasmine flowers each time upon the image of the noble Avalokiteśvara. Vajrapāṇi too should be perfumed with incense. Bowing to the ten directions, one should also offer, in the four directions, tormas of various flavors, along with milk porridge, curd and cooked rice, to the goddess Bhīṣaṇī of the west, Anupamā of the east, Śaṅkhinī of the zenith, and the others. Because of this, no distraction or fear whatsoever will arise for that person, and the mind will not become confused. Having recited one hundred and eight times over each of all the one hundred and eight jasmine flowers, one should make the invocation."

Having first done the approach recitation exactly according to this same rite, then, on the morning of the fifteenth day, one sets four full vases at that place, and also sets out incense, sandalwood, white resin and camphor. Four-sided lamps are set out, and the place is well adorned with flowers, incense, parasols, victory banners, silk streamers, flags of various kinds, and vessels of gold and silver. Milk porridge mixed with honey, curd, cooked rice, and whatever other food offerings and tormas one can afford are also set out in the four directions. As before, one recites once over each of the one hundred and eight jasmine flowers and casts them in the four directions. Then one recites once over each of three times one hundred and eight jasmine flowers, and with them, one by one, one should strike the image of the noble Avalokiteśvara.

Then that image will move, and a great sound will arise. Rays of light will also come forth, and the earth will shake. Then all rites and all aims will be accomplished. One will see the Tathāgata and also attain the bodhisattva grounds. One will become worthy of homage from all beings. One will have an abundance of wealth, grain, treasuries and storehouses. One will be entirely free of all illness and will live long. All enemies, kings, princes and ministers

will wish to see one and will cherish one. One will abandon all afflictions, attachment, aversion and delusion. One will never be parted from those one loves. One will be steadfast, endowed with strength and great diligence, endowed with splendor, of sharp faculties, endowed with intelligence, endowed with a mind of compassion toward all beings, and content. At the time of death one will see the buddhas, the blessed ones, and will also see the noble Avalokiteśvara, and so on, up to passing away while abiding in loving-kindness and teaching the Dharma. One will be born in whatever kind of buddhafield one wishes, or in the great family of a wheel-turning monarch, or wherever one directs one's recollection, and one will also obtain many thousands of other qualities.

He said, "Blessed One, this being so, this Dharma discourse and these bases of the secret mantra of the dhāraṇī are a source of many qualities. Without the blessing of the Tathāgata, no one is able to hear this Dharma discourse, nor able to hold it, nor able to read it, nor able to worship it, nor able to write it out, nor able to have it written out, nor able to have faith in it. Even if one should see it, one will not listen to it. Even if one should listen to it, one will listen with a distracted mind and will not have faith, and will not honor it. Even if one should honor it, one will honor it with a mind full of afflictions and malice. Even if one should write it out or have it written out, one will be thinking of other things. And why is that? Because it is the result of one's former karma: one is experiencing that karma, and doubt arises.

"Even one who has committed the five acts of immediate retribution, if he practices this three times, will have all his hopes fulfilled. In this, one should be without hesitation, without two-mindedness, and should not give rise to doubt."

Then the Blessed One gave his approval to the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara: "Excellent, son of noble family, excellent! This Dharma discourse will perform the deeds of a tathāgata for all beings."

Then the great yakṣiṇī Anupamā went to where the Blessed One was. When she had arrived, she made offerings to the Blessed One of flowers, perfumes, various kinds of incense, and pairs of fine cotton garments, touched her head to the Blessed One's feet, and said this to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, I recall that, in the presence of the Blessed One when he was staying in the park of Sarasvatī in the land of Kauśāmbī, I made a pledge for the benefit, help and happiness of all beings. Blessed One, we too wish for the

heart essences of all the holders of vidyā-mantras. Therefore, for the help of many people, for the happiness of many people, for the complete fulfillment of all hopes, and for the sake of monks, nuns, laymen and laywomen, may the Blessed One please accept me.

namaḥ sarva tathāgatānān syud ya the dan ha ha hi hi hu hu sara sara la hūṃ la hūṃ śīghraṃ mahāvidyā sarva vidyādhara namaskrīte hasa hasa kiṃ tiṣṭhasi kiṃ kiṃ tiṣṭhasi kanaka vicitra āvaraṇa vibhūṣitāṃge paṭa paṭa bhara bhara bhiri bhiri bhuru bhuru sarva arthana me sādhaya turu turu arthana sādhaya arthana dehi me sarva satvānān siddhina hā hā padme padme mahāpadme viṣade viṣade mahāviṣade bhava bhava bhavod bhavāya tam haṃ ghore tan me vidyāma prayojanāya siddhi kuru sarva āśā me paripūraya buddha adhiṣṭhānena svāhā

"Blessed One, whoever wishes for qualities, wishes for wealth and grain, wishes to bring all beings under his power, and wishes for great lordship over wealth, for kingship, for the state of a great holder of vidyā-mantras, and also to see me directly, should do as follows. On the eighth day of the month, on a fresh white cloth with its fringe uncut and cleared of hairs, a pure painter who observes the fast and keeps the noble eight precepts, using paints not mixed with glue and placed in new vessels, should paint in the center an image of the Tathāgata seated in the manner of teaching the Dharma. On the right should be painted the noble Vajrakrodha, clad in white garments, adorned with all ornaments, a flower garland, crescent ornaments and a necklace, brandishing a vajra.

On the left side should be drawn the great yakṣiṇī Anupamā, pale white like the color of the reed used for arrows, wearing white garments, adorned with every ornament, holding a lotus in her hand, in the attitude of giving comfort.

Then the vidyā-mantra holder should be pure, keeping the fasting observance and the eightfold noble precepts. He should wear white garments, have a companion, and eat barley rice mixed with milk, and in this way first perform the approach. On the eighth day, in the daytime, in a clean place that holds relics of a tathāgata, he should first of all offer flowers, incense and perfumes to the Tathāgata and to Vajrapāṇi. In the four directions he should scatter tormas of milk porridge, curd and rice, with various flavors and various colors. Having worshiped with flowers, incense, perfumes and various lamps, three times a day he should take three times one hundred and eight jasmine flowers, recite the mantra three times one hundred and eight times over them,

and strike that image of the great yakṣiṇī Anupamā with them one by one.

Then on the fifteenth day, the day of the full moon, he should perform this same rite once more. He should also offer whatever else he can obtain: incense, camphor, white resin, sandalwood and fragrant wood. He should also offer lamps with two wicks, filled with scented sesame oil.

Then I shall stay there in my own form, and I shall grant whatever supreme thing he wishes: the attainment of meditative absorption, going through the sky, making the body invisible, kingship, the state of a universal monarch of power, the state of a vidyādhara, the seeing of treasures, the knowledge of transmuting wealth, the knowledge of others' minds, and long life. Whatever supreme thing he wishes, I shall grant.

He, for his part, should make his mind one of loving-kindness toward all sentient beings, a mind that has completely abandoned pride, anger, jealousy and avarice. He should completely give up stealing the property of stūpas, of the Dharma and of the Saṅgha, and his faith in the tathāgatas should be unshakable.

Blessed One, if even someone who has committed the deeds of immediate retribution performs the practice three times and I do not grant it, then, Blessed One, may I not fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Even to those who have no faith in the Buddha, to whoever is in doubt, to those who commit evil, nonvirtuous deeds and feel no remorse, and to whoever has a mind of afflictions and secondary afflictions, even to them I shall grant the sight of me, and I shall let them attain as well.

Then the Blessed One gave his approval to the great yakṣiṇī Anupamā, saying, "Excellent, sister, excellent! Sister, for the sake of all sentient beings you have spoken such secret mantra procedures as these for beings who constantly commit evil, and you have also made a pledge. Excellent again! By such great compassion as this you will be able to establish all sentient beings in unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. So you must do just that."

Then the great goddess Śaṅkhinī worshiped the Blessed One with various flowers and various perfumes, circumambulated him, touched the Blessed One's two feet, and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, I too, through the blessing of the Tathāgata, shall make the teaching of the Tathāgata endure for a long time, and I pledge to protect those who teach the Dharma. I shall grant secret mantra procedures that fulfill all hopes. Therefore, may the Blessed One please give me permission.

namaḥ sarba tathāgatānāna tadyathā oṃ śaṅkhini debi āgaccha āgaccha tiṣṭha dhane dhanajaye bri bri bridhīkari dhri dhri dhritikari nānābibidha beśabasta āyudhadhāriṇi yuyu āyuṣpālane tathāgatānāṃ smarabodhicittaṃ māBilamba dehimebaran śaṃkhini svāhā

"Blessed One, if one keeps these secret mantra procedures on one's body, one's fame will increase, and one's splendor, wealth and power will increase, one will be long-lived, and one's ability to bring enemies under control will increase as well. In a clean spot or in a temple one should offer tormas of whatever is available in the four directions, make extensive worship to the Tathāgata with incense and white resin, and also offer lamps. If for twenty-one days one abides in loving-kindness, keeps strictly to the observance, and recites the mantra one hundred and eight times, I shall fulfill all the wishes of everyone except those who reject the true Dharma."

Then the Blessed One and the assembly, just as it had gathered, gave their approval to the great goddess Śaṅkhinī, saying, "Excellent, sister, excellent! This pledge, endowed with many qualities, is well spoken. Sister, you must do just that in times to come."

Then the great goddess Bhīṣaṇī worshiped the Blessed One with golden flowers, touched the Blessed One's two feet with her head, and said to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, I too shall bestow mantra formulas for the sake of those who teach the Dharma, those who listen to the Dharma, those who write it down, who keep it, who read it, and who make offerings to it. These formulas fulfill every hope; they bring riches, jewels, pearls, wealth, power, kingship and long life; and they bring all enemies under control. If any king, queen, monk, nun, layman or laywoman keeps this teaching, reads it, venerates it, writes it down, has it written down, or with the utmost devotion carries out the practice as it has been taught, then, Blessed One, I will protect that person and watch over them, and I will grant whatever boon they wish. I will see that they are never parted from wealth and power. I will make them victorious in fights, quarrels, brawls and riots. I will bring them a life that is perfect in every way. I will also watch over their land and their cities. Therefore I beg the Blessed One to give me his permission.

namaḥ sarba tathāgatānān sarba bodhisatvānān nama āryābalokiteśvara bajrapāṇiprabhṛtīnān tadyathā oṃ mahādebi bhime bhīmamate jaye jayābahe yaśobati yaśojabe tejajabe byākaraṇaprāpate sarbasatva abalokite

kripatejabahule tathāgate anujñātam pālaya smara pratijñāma buddha adhiṣṭhānena dehi me baran siddhiṃ kuru debi mahādebistyabecana debi bhime satyabacana prateṣṭhite guhyanibāsini svāhā

"Blessed One, for the sake of all sentient beings I have spoken these mantra formulas, which are blessed by the Tathāgata and permitted by the Tathāgata. If one makes offerings before the Tathāgata with flowers, incense, perfumes and lamps, gives tormas of milk porridge and of many flavors to the four directions, keeps in mind whatever one wishes, and makes offering by reciting the mantra one hundred and eight times, then every one of those hopes will be fulfilled.

"Whoever wishes to see my own form should do this. On the eighth day of the month, a pure painter who has taken the eightfold observance of the noble ones should take a new white cloth with its fringe uncut and free of hairs, and, using paints not mixed with glue and placed in new vessels, should paint in the center an image of the Tathāgata seated in the manner of teaching the Dharma. On the right side should be painted the noble Avalokiteśvara giving a discourse on the Dharma. On the left side should be painted the great goddess Bhīṣaṇī, pale white like the color of an arrow reed, wearing white garments, adorned with every ornament, holding a vase and a rosary, and appearing in the manner of one who gives solace.

"Then a pure holder of vidyā-mantras, having first completed the approach, should from the eighth to the fifteenth day of the month make offerings of flowers, incense, perfumes and garlands at a place where there is a stūpa containing relics. He should scatter tormas of milk porridge, curd and cooked rice to the four directions, make lavish offerings of flowers, incense and lamps of many kinds, and also present white food offerings. Having given tormas of many flavors and whatever else he can afford, he should, with a mind of loving-kindness and a mind of compassion toward all sentient beings, recite the mantra one hundred and eight times over one hundred and eight jasmine flowers, and cast them one by one onto that image of the great goddess Bhīṣaṇī.

"Then I will appear there in my own form and grant whatever boon is wished: sovereign power over a kingdom, travel through the sky, the sight of hidden treasures, the transmutation of wealth, the state of a vidyādhara, the averting of untimely death, the complete pacification of all illnesses, the utter defeat of enemy armies, the gift of sons, the gathering of wealth, the arising of

loving-kindness toward all sentient beings, and whatever other activities are wished for.

"Blessed One, setting aside only those who reject the true Dharma and those who have doubts about the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha, if I should fail to fulfill all the hopes of anyone, even of one who has committed the five deeds of immediate retribution, then, Blessed One, may I never fully awaken into unsurpassed, perfect and complete enlightenment!"

The Blessed One said, "Excellent, sister, excellent! Sister, you have set out for the sake of the welfare, benefit and happiness of all sentient beings, and you have set out so that this Dharma discourse may long endure; that too is excellent of you. Therefore, sister, always remember this vow."

At that moment this great earth shook violently, a rain of divine flowers poured down, and that entire assembly also gave its approval, saying, "Excellent, sister, excellent! You have spoken well in making this vow to fulfill all the hopes of all sentient beings."

Then the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara, said this to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, what kind of merit will be obtained by a son or daughter of noble family who writes down this Dharma discourse, has it written down, reads it, worships it, teaches it correctly, recites it, and chants it?"

The Blessed One said, "Noble Avalokiteśvara, I shall ask you yourself about this. Answer it as you see fit."

Avalokiteśvara said, "Blessed One, there is nothing that the Tathāgata has not seen, not heard, not considered, or not fully known. Therefore, may the Blessed One himself please speak."

The Blessed One said, "Son of noble family, the merit obtained from writing down this Dharma discourse, having it written down, reading it, worshiping it, teaching it correctly, reciting it, and chanting it cannot be expressed even by an example. Why is that? Suppose one fully satisfied all sentient beings, each according to their wishes, with clothing, ornaments, wealth, gold, jewels, and pearls, and kept them in delight. Even so, those beings would not be completely freed from birth, aging, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness, and agitation. And suppose one kept them in delight for a hundred thousand years with the five qualities of sensual pleasure. Even so, those beings would not be completely freed from the hells, from birth as

animals, from the world of Yama, and from the realm of the hungry ghosts. But when, for the sake of sentient beings, one listens to this Dharma discourse, worships it, teaches it correctly, listens to its meaning as well, and diligently puts it into practice, that leads only to complete freedom from birth, aging, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness, and agitation, and from all the hells, births as animals, and the world of Yama. For that reason the Tathāgata gives no example for the measure of its merit.

"Son of noble family, consider someone who, for the sake of this Dharma discourse and of those who proclaim this Dharma, uphold it, read it, write it down, and worship it, gives away wealth no greater than a mustard seed, or a single flower, or a single fruit, or a banner, or the sound of music, or incense, or clothing, or even a single ornament; or who writes it down, has it written down, keeps it, reads it, worships it, teaches it correctly, honors it, or teaches it correctly and extensively to others as well. And consider someone else who, for a hundred thousand years, worships the Tathāgata and his retinue, present before his very eyes, with offerings of flowers, incense, perfumes, garlands, ointments, parasols, victory banners, and banners; who makes offerings to him, venerates him, and serves him with every requisite of comfort; who has monasteries, walkways, and parks built, or has stupas of the seven precious substances built for the Tathāgata, a hundred or a thousand half-yojanas in height, and worships them with offerings for a hundred thousand years. Far more than that, the one who writes down this Dharma discourse, has it written down, keeps it, reads it, recites it, worships it, and teaches it correctly will generate a far greater accumulation of merit. Making offerings to the Tathāgata in person is not like this, nor is giving gifts to all sentient beings and keeping them in delight with the five qualities of sensual pleasure.

"Therefore sons and daughters of noble family, kings, princes, great ministers, and ministers should always and continually worship this Dharma discourse. They should regard as the Tathāgata himself those spiritual friends who proclaim this Dharma discourse, who expound it, and who also bring its meaning into practice. Having honored them, they should listen to this Dharma discourse, take it up, keep it, read it, and bear it in mind. And they should also give rise to this thought:

"'We perceive meaning in what is meaningless, permanence in what is impermanent, and happiness in what is suffering, and we have entered upon what is not the path. Whoever shows us the path, and whoever performs the deeds of a Tathāgata in order to free us completely from the hells, from birth

as animals, and from the world of Yama, in finding such a one I have found a great gain indeed.' This is the thought they should give rise to."

Avalokiteśvara said, "Blessed One, in teaching this Dharma discourse correctly to all sentient beings, you have performed the great deed of a Tathāgata."

The Blessed One said, "Son of noble family, in the future, in the last times, this Dharma discourse will circulate in the regions of the south. There too will arise monks, nuns, laymen, laywomen, kings, princes, great ministers, and ministers who are worthy vessels, who will worship it, uphold it, and read it, and they will have faith in it and trust in it."

If it comes to circulate in the lands of the north, the east and the west, there will also be people there who do not listen to it, who have no faith in it, who do not trust it, and who make no offerings to it. They are weak in diligence and forgetful. They are distracted by wife and children, by servants and maidservants, by wealth and power, by laughter and flirtation, by dancing, by performances and by songs of every kind. Through thoughts of jealousy and avarice they do not listen and do not trust. Those beings are intent on the work of Māra. They will never be fully freed from birth, aging, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness and turmoil, nor from the hells, the animal realm, the world of Yama, and the domain of the hungry ghosts.

Therefore, sons and daughters of good family who wish to free themselves completely from all the lower realms should pay honor to this Dharma discourse and make offerings to it. They should also teach it correctly to others, and they should keep it in mind.

In times of strife and conflict, of bad dreams and evil omens, of untimely death, of cattle disease, livestock disease and human disease, and of illness, fear and harms of every kind, one should make offerings to this Dharma discourse and recite it. One should raise a victory banner and make offerings with flowers, incense, perfumes and the sounds of various kinds of music, scatter torma in the four directions, and pay homage with flowers, incense and perfumes. If one then brings it in, all epidemic disease, all harm and all contagious disease there will be completely pacified.

Then the Blessed One spoke these verses:

What the Guide proclaimed in former existences
For the sake of taking all beings into his care,
And what I too now explain to you,

This samādhi, Ānanda, hold it fast!

Compared with one who offers the three realms as a gift
To the Jewels of the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha,
If one makes offerings to this sūtra,
That gift cannot even serve as a comparison.

Compared with one who, with faith in the Buddha,
Builds monasteries beyond measure,
Whoever holds this sūtra
Will have far greater merit than that.

Whoever scatters even a single flower,
Or likewise offers cloth, garlands or ointments,
Paying honor to this samādhi,
The former heap of merit does not equal a fraction of it.

Whoever, to honor this sūtra,
Gives the gift of a single kārṣāpaṇa coin,
And for the sake of awakening gives rise to loving-kindness,
Obtains far greater merit than that.

The bodhisattva who explains this samādhi to beings,
Who gives them its transmission, and likewise
Establishes them on the way to unsurpassed awakening,
His merit is beyond any comparison.

Therefore, having heard of these benefits,
And likewise holding all beings in loving-kindness,
One should take up this sūtra and write it out,
Recite it, and likewise explain it.

Harmed by aging, and likewise by sickness and death,
Tormented by hundreds of fierce sufferings,
When they are born among the hell beings and hungry ghosts,
How bitterly they will regret it in later times!

At the time of death, terrified and afraid in mind,
Again and again they will cry out,
"Who will be my ally, my kinsman and my refuge?"
So those of childish mind will wonder among themselves.

Because they did not honor the Tathāgata,
And stole the wealth of the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha,
They will be led to the terrible world of Yama,
And from then on there will never be any refuge at all.

There is no wife or child, there are no kin or relations,
There is no kingdom or retinue, no laughter or flirtation;
Wealth and grain, and likewise clothes and ornaments,
All are left behind, and suffering never ends, again and again.

Because they did not have faith in this samādhi,
They will experience such unending suffering.
Hearing of this suffering and of those benefits,
Who, even of childish mind, would not give rise to faith?

Therefore always the monks and the nuns,
The lay followers, and the king with his court,
Should always take up this sūtra,
And always pay honor to those who hold it.

Then the venerable Ānanda said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I have taken up this Dharma discourse. I shall hold it with the perception that it is the Teacher himself, and I shall teach it correctly to all beings."

The Blessed One said: "Ānanda, if, having heard whatever Dharma I have taught and having grasped it all, you were not to retain all of it, not to recite it, and not to spread it, you would not thereby have wronged me, nor would you have listened without respect, nor would you cease to be a śrāvaka. But if you do not retain this Dharma discourse, do not recite it, do not make offerings to it, do not teach it correctly, and do not keep it in mind, then you will have wronged me, you will have listened without respect, and you will not be a śrāvaka. Therefore, Ānanda, you should hold this Dharma discourse with devoted care. In a future time, in a later age, it will perform the deeds of a tathāgata for all beings through the unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening of the Tathāgata."

When the Blessed One had taught this Dharma discourse, the minds of sixty thousand living beings were liberated from the defilements without clinging. Seven hundred bodhisattvas attained samādhi. Five hundred received the prophecy that they would be born in various buddha fields. Ninety thousand living beings were liberated from all the afflictions and left behind all the unfavorable states, the lower realms and the bad destinies.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara, also said this to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, in the future, in times to come, there will be sons and daughters of good family who listen to this Dharma discourse, who hold it, who honor it and worship it, and who write it down. For them, the work of the Tathāgata will be done, and they will be prophesied to whatever different buddha fields they wish.

"In the future, in times to come, there will be beings who are distracted in all sorts of ways by laughter, flirtation, dance, revelry, and the sounds of song and music. Their darkness of attachment, aversion and delusion will be great. They will take amusement to be joy and the impermanent to be permanent, and they will be gripped by jealousy and avarice. They will not worship this discourse, will not honor it, will not have faith in it, will not trust it, will not keep it, will not read it, will not listen to it, and will not diligently put it into practice. Grown weary of this labor, and having used up the fruit of their former karma, they will experience suffering, unhappiness of every kind, and the sufferings of the hells. There too they will experience suffering for many hundreds of millions of eons, and then again they will be born in the hells, in the animal realm, and in the world of Yama. Because they fell under the sway of nonvirtuous friends, they will regret it for a long time.

"Therefore one should restrain body, speech and mind well, and one should have unshakable faith in the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha. Toward all sentient beings, one should cultivate a mind of loving-kindness, a mind that has entirely given up jealousy, avarice and corrupt moral discipline, and a mind that has entirely given up anger."

Then the assembly, just as it had gathered, each with the merit they had accumulated, made offerings to the Tathāgata of divine flowers, incense, perfumes, garlands, ointments, garments and ornaments, with joyful cries of "Alala!", the sound of laughter, divine cymbals, clapping of hands and songs. Then they exclaimed, "Excellent! Blessed One, excellent, excellent! For the benefit of all sentient beings, and so that the Tathāgata's teaching may long endure, you have spoken this great Dharma discourse exceedingly well."

Then the venerable Ānanda said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, what is the name of this Dharma discourse? How should it be remembered?"

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, therefore, remember this Dharma discourse as Sanctioned by All Tathāgatas and Treading the Grounds of the Bodhisattvas. Remember it also as The Great Gathering of Magical Displays of Miraculous Power. Remember it also as Beholding Beings with the Blessing of All Tathāgatas and Fully Displaying the Arrays of Buddha Fields."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the noble Avalokiteśvara, Mañjuśrī, Vajrapāṇi and all the other bodhisattva great beings; all the great śrāvakas; Śakra (Indra), Brahmā and all the world guardians; the Four Great Kings; the great yakṣiṇīs Anupamā, Vimalaprabhā, Prabhāvatī, Bhīṣaṇī, Śrīmatī, Śaṅkhinī, Hārītī and the others; all the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras and mahoragas; the whole assembly just as it had gathered; and the assemblies of monks, nuns, laymen and laywomen, rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This completes the noble Mahāyāna sūtra called Beholding Beings with the Blessing of All Tathāgatas and Fully Displaying the Arrays of Buddha Fields.

It was revised and finalized by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Surendrabodhi and the chief editor and translator, the monk Yeshé Dé. It was translated, revised and finalized by the monk Lu'i Gyaltsen.

Herein is contained the Sūtra section, volume Ga.

Translator's Notes

• Several of the bodhisattva and yakṣiṇī names are reconstructed from their Tibetan meaning and are not securely attested: Dhanaśrī ("Wealth Glory"), Vidyutketu ("Lightning Banner"), Amṛtaketu ("Nectar Banner"), Prabhāvatī ("Radiant One"), Bhīṣaṇī ("Terrifying One"), Śrīmatī ("Glorious One"), and Śaṅkhinī ("Conch-Bearer"). The phrase describing the arhats, "reached the far shore of supreme mastery over all sentient beings," follows the Tibetan literally. The parallel stock formula usually speaks of mastery over one's own mind.
• The phrase rendered "may be left with nothing further to hope for" literally reads "may become without hope"; in context, paired with "will not need to come back again," it is taken to mean that their wishes are fully satisfied rather than that they despair.
• The Tathāgata's name, Fully Displaying the Light of Flowers, is translated from the Tibetan, since its Sanskrit form could not be confidently identified. The phrase rendered "great sovereignty" is the term that elsewhere denotes Maheśvara (Śiva). Here it stands in a list of benefits and is plural, so it is taken in its literal sense of great lordship or mastery, not as the god's name.
• The name of the tathāgata in whose presence Vajrapāṇi received the dhāraṇī is translated from the Tibetan as "Fearless Array, King of Splendor." A Sanskrit form along the lines of Abhayavyūhatejorāja is plausible, but it could not be confirmed. The illness terms bro nad and lus bro 'tshal ba are rendered as "fevers" and "bodily pains," and their exact sense is uncertain.
• "One span in height" reads □□□□□ as an evident slip for □□□□□□ ("one span"); as written it

would be "a horse's measure," which makes little sense here. The phrase rendered "the rite that fully brings to life" (literally "fully causing to breathe") seems to refer to the consecration of the image.
• "The roots of virtue that lead to a prophecy" renders a compressed phrase that could also be read as "roots of virtue that have been foretold." "Revere" renders a Tibetan idiom that literally means "to make into a picture." It is the standard rendering of Sanskrit citrīkāra, a term of reverence.
• The tathāgata's name, rendered here as "Light-Making Wisdom Crest," and the dhāraṇī's title, "the Miracle of Full Beholding," are translated from the Tibetan because their Sanskrit forms cannot be confirmed with confidence. "Anupamā" for the goddess of the east is a reconstruction of "the Unequaled One" and is not certain.
• The phrase "park of Sarasvatī" renders the Tibetan as given; since the famous monastic park at Kauśāmbī is the Ghoṣitārāma, this may be a rendering of that name (ghoṣa, "voice"), but the reading is not certain. The word rendered "garments" in the description of Vajrakrodha is written rad pa, which appears to be a slip for ras pa, "cloth, garments." The name Anupamā is reconstructed from the Tibetan "Incomparable One."
• "Fragrant wood" renders shing mus, which I could not identify with confidence. "Lamps with two wicks" is a tentative reading of zhugs mar kha gnyis, literally "two-mouthed lamp oil." The name Anupamā is reconstructed from dpe med ma, "the Incomparable One."
• "Transmutation of wealth" renders □□□□□□□□□, probably meaning the alchemical turning of substances into precious metal. "Illnesses" renders □□□□□□, whose exact sense is uncertain; it may refer to fevers or epidemic disease. "Gives solace" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (Skt. āśvāsana, consoling or reassuring).
• Here □□□□□ means "regions" or "lands," not "tantra." The phrase rendered "you have performed the great deed of a Tathāgata" is somewhat ambiguous in the Tibetan. It could also be read as saying that the discourse was taught by "the one who performs the great deeds of a Tathāgata." The verb □□□□□□□□□□□□ is unusual. It is rendered "venerates" from context.
• "If one then brings it in" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□ literally; the sense is probably that the honored text is carried into the afflicted place or community.
• "Honor" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ in its idiomatic sense of showing respect (citrīkāra) rather than "drawing." The final line is an editorial volume marker. "□□□" is read here as the volume letter Ga, but its exact form is uncertain.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.